

Additional References for Sermon Development

This reference set is designed to support the Braselton sermon, especially the Demas-Luke contrast, the theme of first love, and the Adventist corrective of Sabbath-centered reordering. I prioritized Scripture first, then Ellen G. White sources, and then a few useful angles for further expansion.

1. Essential biblical texts

Demas texts

- Colossians 4:14 - Demas appears in the fellowship of gospel workers.
- Philemon 1:23-24 - Demas is named among Paul's fellow laborers.
- 2 Timothy 4:9-11 - the crisis text: Demas forsakes Paul, while Luke remains.

Luke texts

- Colossians 4:14 - Luke as "the beloved physician"
- 2 Timothy 4:11 - "Only Luke is with me"
- Luke 9:23 - the cost of discipleship
- Luke 14:25-33 - counting the cost
- Luke 18:28-30 - leaving all for Christ

First-love and allegiance texts

- Revelation 2:1-5 - the church of Ephesus loses first love without losing activity
- 1 John 2:15-17 - do not love the world
- Matthew 6:21 - heart follows treasure
- John 21:15-17 - Christ's repeated question: "Lovest thou me?"
- Philippians 3:7-8 - counting all loss for Christ

Sabbath and reordered love texts

- Exodus 20:8-11 - Sabbath as memorial of the Creator
- Deuteronomy 5:12-15 - Sabbath as memorial of redemption
- Isaiah 58:13-14 - Sabbath as delight
- Hebrews 4:9-11 - deeper rest language that can support the "Sabbath of the soul" idea

2. Ellen G. White sources

All links below are from official EGW Writings pages that I checked while preparing this sermon pack.

Demas as tragic exchange

- Acts of the Apostles, p. 455.2

- Official link: AA 455.2
- Use for: Demas as a man who bartered eternal value for worldly gain.
- Sermon use: This supports your line that Demas did not simply make a mistake; he made an exchange of loves.

Luke as faithful presence beside Paul

- **Acts of the Apostles, p. 490.2**
- Official link: AA 490.2
- Use for: Luke as "the beloved physician and faithful friend" whose services comforted Paul in prison.
- Sermon use: This strengthens the Luke contrast without making him theatrical.

Luke as model for medical mission

- **Evangelism, p. 543.4**
- Official link: Ev 543.4
- Use for: Luke as a physician whose healing ministry opened doors for the gospel.
- Sermon use: Especially useful because it connects naturally with your physician-preacher identity.

Ephesus in first love

- **Acts of the Apostles, pp. 578-579**
- Official links: AA 578-579 and AA 578.3-579.1
- Use for: the early believers' fervor, simplicity, and love for Christ.
- Sermon use: helpful for the "remember" side of Revelation 2:5.

Ephesus losing first love

- **Acts of the Apostles, pp. 547-548**
- Official text page: AA 547-548
- Use for: the gradual change from living love to outward form and criticism.
- Sermon use: this is one of the strongest parallels to Demas and to church busyness.

Love as the principle of action

- **Steps to Christ, p. 59.2**
- Official link: SC 59.2
- Use for: "Duty becomes a delight, and sacrifice a pleasure."
- Sermon use: place this after the Luke section or in the appeal.

Consecration and the whole heart

- **Steps to Christ, pp. 43-44**
- Official link: SC 43-44
- Use for: the whole heart must be yielded, and a profession without deep love is dry formality.
- Sermon use: valuable for sharpening the first-love appeal.

Prayer, communion, and busyness

- **Testimonies for the Church, vol. 5, p. 161**
- Official link: 5T 161
- Use for: hurried prayer and the absence of real communion with God.
- Sermon use: excellent for diagnosing the Demas condition in respectable believers.

Sabbath as spiritual bearing on all of life

- **Testimonies for the Church, vol. 6, p. 353.3**
- Official link: 6T 353.3
- Use for: Sabbath's spiritual bearing on all the transactions of life.
- Sermon use: supports your claim that Sabbath is not mere legal pause, but a whole-life reordering.

Sabbath as joy, not dead inactivity

- **The Desire of Ages, p. 207.2**
- Official link: DA 207.2
- Use for: Sabbath is not useless inactivity, but rest, worship, and holy deeds.
- Sermon use: useful if you want to protect the sermon from sounding legalistic.

Sabbath as delight in Christ

- **The Desire of Ages, pp. 288-289**
- Official compilation link: RRe 331.5 quoting DA 288-289
- Use for: those who receive Sabbath as Christ's sign delight themselves in Him.
- Sermon use: powerful for the final Adventist turn.

3. Additional sermon angles you can develop if desired

Angle A - Demas and Laodicea

You can connect Demas to the Laodicean condition in Revelation 3:

- rich in appearance
- poor in what matters
- active, but not hot in love

Use carefully. Revelation 2 fits more directly because of "first love," but Revelation 3 can intensify the Adventist diagnosis.

Angle B - Demas, Luke, and Mark

Acts of the Apostles places Demas and Mark in interesting contrast near Paul's final period. Mark once failed but was restored. Demas once stood but drifted. Luke quietly endured. If you want a threefold pattern, it could be:

- Mark - failure and restoration
- Demas - fellowship and drift
- Luke - steadiness and endurance

That could become a later sermon, or a short mention in this one.

Angle C - The immigrant and professional temptation

This came through strongly in your earlier Nigerian diaspora and Atlanta North work. It is still worth keeping in Braselton, but in a broadened form:

- the temptation to define worth by advancement
- the desire for safety after seasons of struggle
- the subtle exchange of prayerful dependence for functional self-sufficiency

This gives the sermon contemporary weight without narrowing it to one subgroup.

Angle D - Luke as a model for Christian professionals

Luke did not abandon professional identity; he subordinated it. His medical skill became servant, not master. That is a strong word for Christian professionals in medicine, business, education, technology, and ministry.

4. Suggested quotation strategy

For a 30-minute sermon, use no more than 3 or 4 Ellen White quotations aloud. More than that can slow the sermon and reduce force.

Recommended set:

- AA 455.2 on Demas
- AA 490.2 on Luke
- AA 547-548 or Revelation 2 with short paraphrase on first love
- SC 59.2 for the appeal

Optional addition:

- 5T 161 if you want a stronger diagnosis of busyness crowding out communion

5. Recommended sermon structure from these sources

1. Paul's last roll call - 2 Timothy 4:9-11 2. Demas - the tragedy of misplaced affection 3. Luke - the beauty of faithful presence 4. Ephesus - activity without first love 5. Sabbath - the Adventist corrective of reordered devotion 6. Appeal - remember, repent, return

6. Final reminder for preparation

The most compelling use of the Demas material is not to make the congregation fear scandal. It is to make them examine affection. That is where the sermon becomes both biblically faithful and spiritually searching.